

All Welcome. Always Free.



**EXPLORING
UMMA**

A Cultural Hub

A Rich History of Art and Education

The University of Michigan Museum of Art (UMMA) traces its history to 1856, when the university's art collections were first opened to the campus and community, highlighting U-M's early dedication to art education and accessibility.

Founding and Early Vision of the Museum of Art

UMMA was formally established in 1946 as the primary site for engaging with visual art on campus, under the direction of painter Jean Paul Slusser, who recognized the museum's potential for advancing research and enhancing teaching and

learning. In its early years, UMMA shifted its focus from the university's initial emphasis on antiquities to modern and contemporary art, a progressive choice that laid the groundwork for the museum's ongoing evolution and influence in the art world.

Alumni Memorial Hall

UMMA's original Alumni Memorial Hall, funded by alumni, commemorates U-M's Civil and Spanish-American War fallen and houses the art collection.

2009 Expansion

The 2009 expansion added the Frankel Family Wing, doubling UMMA's space for exhibitions, programs, and educational engagement.

Diverse Collections

UMMA's collection now includes over 21,000 objects spanning various cultures and eras, making it one of the premier university art museums in the U.S.

Interdisciplinary Approach

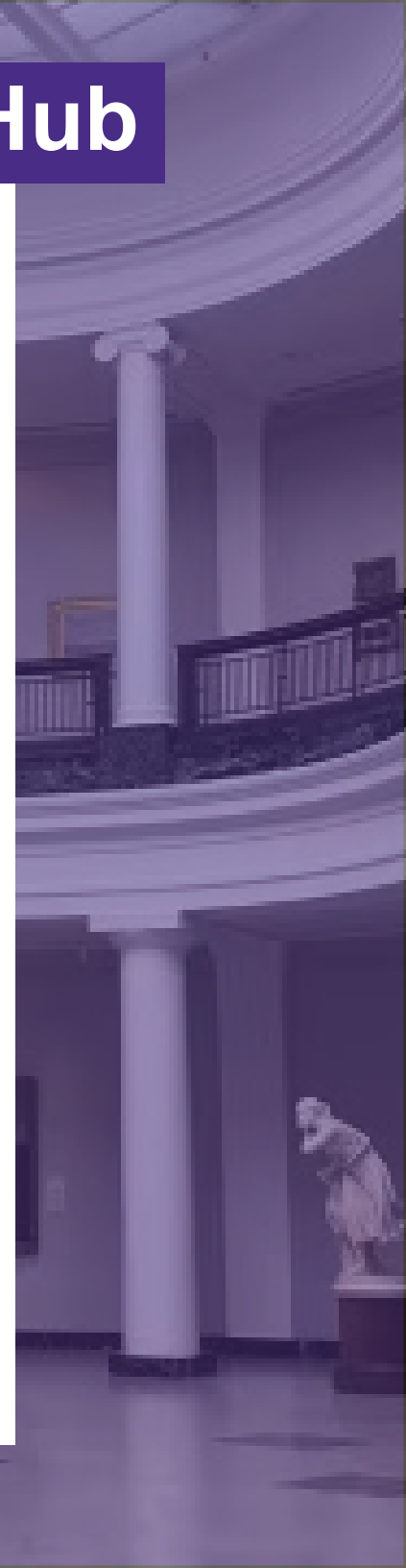
Beyond visual arts, UMMA has become a hub for performing and literary arts, blending global scholarship and adapting to the evolving educational and digital landscape.

Community Engagement

UMMA serves as a lively, inclusive gathering space for students, faculty, and the public, reinforcing its role as a cultural center for campus and the region.

Educational Impact

UMMA supports the university's teaching mission by fostering understanding of art, culture, and self, integrating deeply into campus academic life.



April Greiman: Pioneering Digital Design

April Greiman, born in 1948, is a pioneering American graphic designer who introduced the 'New Wave' style to the U.S. in the late 1970s. Trained under Armin Hofmann and Wolfgang Weingart, she later launched her

design consultancy, Made in Space, in Los Angeles, where she uniquely embraced pixelation and digital "errors." Her innovative approach led her to head CalArts' design department, rebranding it as "Visual Communications."

April Grieman



Known for vibrant colors, layered imagery, and unconventional compositions, Greiman reshaped design norms and pioneered graphic design's digital evolution. An advocate for Macintosh and women in design, she has received numerous honors, including the AIGA Gold Medal. Greiman now teaches at Woodbury University and SCI-Arc, continuing to shape the future of design as a "trans-media artist."

Artworks



April Greiman's *Hand Holding a Bowl of Rice*, completed in 2007, spans seven stories at Los Angeles's Wilshire Vermont Metro Station, marking her shift into large-scale public art. With bold colors and layered design, the mural evokes themes of nourishment and community, showcasing her skill in engaging diverse audiences.

April Greiman's art direction for *Wet Magazine* is a hallmark of 'New Wave' design, showcasing her innovative typography, bold colors, and layered compositions. This cover challenged traditional layouts, inspiring designers and redefining print design in the late 1970s and early 1980s.



John Maeda

A Renaissance Man for the Digital Era

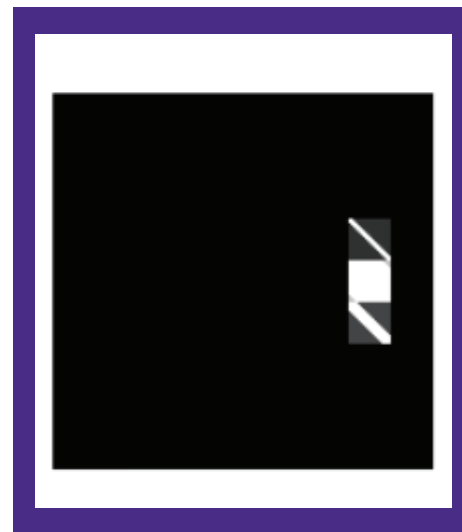
Born in 1966, John Maeda is an innovator in art, design, technology, and education. He earned degrees in Computer Science and Electrical Engineering from MIT, a Ph.D. in Design Science from the University of Tsukuba, and an MBA from Arizona State University. Maeda redefined programming as an artistic medium, influencing interactive motion graphics showcased in institutions like the Museum of Modern Art.

After 12 years at MIT's Media Lab, he became president of the Rhode Island School of Design (RISD) in 2008, promoting the STEM to

STEAM initiative. He has held key tech roles, including VP of Design and AI at Microsoft, and authored influential books like *The Laws of Simplicity*. He is also a sought-after speaker at TED events.



Artworks



The Reactive Square (1994) by John Maeda is an interactive book blending print and digital interactivity. Each page features a black square that transforms in response to sound, with real-time animations. This work introduced interactive art to a wider audience, reflecting Maeda's philosophy of humanizing technology.



12 o'clocks (1996) by John Maeda features twelve digital clock designs that creatively reinterpret time. Each clock uses abstract elements—color, shape, or motion—to present time uniquely, challenging traditional timekeeping concepts and user interface design. This project highlights Maeda's skill in blending simplicity with digital art.

Visitor Information

Hours

Tuesday–Wednesday: 11am–5pm

Thursday–Friday: 10am–8pm

Saturday–Sunday: 11am–8pm

Monday: Closed

Location

525 South State Street, Ann Arbor, MI
48109

Contact

Phone: 734-764-0395

Email: umma-info@umich.edu

Accessibility

UMMA is wheelchair accessible. For specific accommodations, please contact us.

UMMA Shop

Open daily: 11am–5pm

Photography

Non-flash photography allowed

Stay Connected

At UMMA, you're invited to feel challenged, feel inspired, and most importantly, feel free. We look forward to your visit!